

Meeting assets for Piter Garcia (RIT Student)'s Zoom Meeting are ready!

1 message

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**Meeting assets for Piter Garcia (RIT Student)'s Zoom Meeting are ready!****Meeting summary****Quick recap**

The meeting focused on Piter's academic progress and health challenges as a master's student working toward a PhD, including discussions about GRE requirements and course planning. Piter and Sheeraja collaborated on streamlining a research paper, discussing its structure, length requirements, and approach to addressing research questions while planning future publications on various aspects of their work. They also shared personal experiences with neurodivergence and chronic illness, emphasizing the importance of understanding cognitive processes and advocating for oneself while navigating academic and personal challenges.

Next steps

- Piter: Finish integrating Sheeraja's feedback into the paper and notify Sheeraja when complete
- Piter: Email Professor Travis (and optionally CC Sheeraja) to inform that feedback integration is complete and request feedback on the paper
- Piter: Email Professor Dan and Professor Travis to discuss plans for submitting a paper for the Jan 31st deadline, including decisions about which portions to include
- Piter: Create a new Overleaf version of the paper specifically for the 4-page IJCNN submission and add Sheeraja as a collaborator
- Piter: Work on shortening the paper to 4 pages (from current ~30 pages) for IJCNN submission within 15 days
- Sheeraja: Review the paper after Piter completes the feedback integration
- Piter: Send Sheeraja links/resources about the ADHD book mentioned
- Piter: Follow up with Sheeraja via Slack with questions about PhD applications and process
- Sheeraja: Help Piter with the IJCNN submission process since she has experience with this venue

Summary**Academic Planning and Health Updates**

Piter discussed his health issues and current academic status, mentioning that he is a master's student using it as a bridge to a PhD. He explained that he is taking this semester slow to focus on

his work and has postponed some tasks due to illness. Piter also talked about the GRE requirement for PhD applications, with Sheeraja advising him to check with universities about potential waivers based on his US academic experience.

Academic and Research Planning Strategy

Piter discussed their academic plans, focusing on prolonging their master's program to align with completing requirements at the University of Rochester, where they teach computer science and inclusion to elementary students with special needs. They explained their strategy of taking additional research-based courses to strengthen their ability to write papers and prepare for PhD applications, with the goal of starting a PhD in 2027. Piter shared their interest in fairness and equity in algorithms, particularly in medical diagnosis using AI models, which aligns with their ongoing research and future academic pursuits.

Neurodivergent Educator's Personal Journey

Piter shared his personal journey of discovering his neurodivergence and how it affected his academic and professional experiences. He described challenges with traditional teaching methods and quiz formats, which exacerbated his difficulties. Piter explained how he adapted by memorizing material and using AI to help structure his thoughts. He also discussed his decision to pursue a career in teaching neurodivergent students and special needs, supported by a scholarship. Piter mentioned he is close to completing his computer science teaching and inclusion certificates, with plans to continue research on improving education for neurodivergent students.

Research Paper Refinement Discussion

Piter and Sheeraja discussed the progress and challenges of a research paper, focusing on integrating feedback and making the document more concise. Piter shared updates on referencing, sharing specific sections with Professor Travis, and the need to reduce the paper's length by cutting repetitive sections. Sheeraja suggested removing the entire research questions section to streamline the document. Piter acknowledged the need to focus on the main objectives and avoid overcomplicating the paper, while also aiming to validate results with other papers and ensure replicability.

Research Paper Structure Optimization

Sheeraja and Piter discussed the structure and length of a research paper, focusing on the inclusion of research questions and experimental design sections. They agreed that these sections could be condensed, as many papers only briefly mention research questions in the introduction. They also discussed the page limit for the IJCNN venue, which is 6 pages including references, and considered the possibility of using an appendix. Piter expressed concern about following Professor Travis's guidance on formatting and wording, as the referenced papers were longer than the required 6 pages. They concluded that the paper could be focused on one main finding, with other observations mentioned briefly, and that redundancy in addressing research questions multiple times could be reduced.

Research Paper Simplification Discussion

Piter and Sheeraja discussed simplifying a research paper by reducing the number of research questions from nine to three main questions addressed in a single paragraph. They agreed that the current detailed breakdown of questions was causing the paper to be too lengthy. Piter mentioned having a document outlining communications with Dan about the paper's structure, which they intended to review further to streamline the content. They considered focusing on one key aspect, such as capacity or the informative context model, while moving related findings to a journal article.

Research Framework and Paper Planning

Piter explained his computer performance issues due to multiple open browser tabs and documents, which affected his ability to work on and share a diagram. They discussed a plan to publish multiple papers, with the first focusing on a comprehensive framework for testing across different scenarios, followed by papers on IC maps, hybrid models, and benchmarking. Piter outlined the structure of his research, including evaluations of baseline models, hybrid models, and dynamic routing strategies, and suggested that they could focus on specific aspects for future papers.

Dynamic Routing Paper Strategy

Piter and Sheeraja discussed the scope and approach for a paper submission due in 15 days. They agreed to focus on the dynamic routing findings and capacity strategy, rather than conducting a comprehensive evaluation of all models. Sheeraja suggested combining two of the six models into the paper, potentially adding a new metric or aspect to differentiate it from survey papers. Piter planned to email Dan and include Professor Travis for feedback on this approach, as well as discuss the possibility of validating only one testbed due to time constraints. They also considered including a future work section for additional evaluations that could be published later.

Uncertainty Estimation Collaboration Plan

Piter and Sheeraja discussed integrating uncertainty estimation into Piter's existing code, but agreed it would not be feasible for their current paper due to time constraints. They decided to collaborate on implementing this feature for a future paper, with Sheeraja offering to share her code to help Piter better understand how to integrate it. They also discussed the need to rewrite the replay buffer class, which Piter currently lacks, and agreed that working together would be more efficient given their respective expertise.

Uncertainty-Based Sampling Collaboration

Sheeraja explained her work on a new exploration method that uses uncertainty to prioritize sampling from the replay buffer, contrasting with existing methods that use TD error. Piter expressed interest in incorporating this into his own work, and they agreed to collaborate on integrating Sheeraja's code as a base while Piter adds a quantum framework layer. Piter clarified he would not modify Sheeraja's existing code but would work with her on implementing the new uncertainty estimator. They discussed the need for a working session to modify the code together, and Sheeraja offered to help with Piter's January 31st paper if needed.

Paper Progress and ADHD Discussion

Piter and Sheeraja discussed the progress of a paper, with Piter planning to finalize it and seek feedback from Travis and Dan. Sheeraja agreed to review the updated version and provide input. They also shared personal experiences with ADHD and coping mechanisms, highlighting the challenges faced when adapting to new environments. Piter expressed gratitude for Sheeraja's help and support in completing the paper.

Chronic Illness and Academic Support

Piter shared personal experiences about living with chronic illness and how it affected their relationships and mental health, emphasizing the importance of understanding one's own cognitive processes and advocating for oneself. They discussed the challenges of balancing responsibilities and the need for supportive structures in personal and academic environments. Piter expressed gratitude for Sheeraja's help and experience in the PhD process, as they plan to collaborate on applications and share feedback. Sheeraja, who is in her fourth year of a PhD program, shared her progress and goals, expressing willingness to support Piter in his academic journey.

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